

Carpool Optimization Strategy — Date TBD

Participants

- Domain Expert
- Product Manager

The Core Idea / Problem Being Solved

The meeting focused on improving carpool logistics for drivers and riders, addressing the inefficiencies where drivers begin their trips from home, leading to challenges when riders live far away. The current manual organization limits vehicle capacity, forcing individuals to travel long distances to join carpools. These inefficiencies make other modes of transport, like trains, more attractive, indicating a need for a better system to coordinate carpool logistics.

Proposed Solution / MVP Scope

The proposed solution includes limiting trip deviations for drivers to 10-15 minutes and implementing features to display the time differences between direct routes and detours. Users can indicate if they're driving and the number of available seats, reducing the need for manual coordination. Additionally, a simple chat or Discord bot will be used to manage carpool logistics, allowing users to express carpool interest while defaulting to solo travel.

Key Decisions Made

- Prioritize carpooling feature creation over session history tracking.
- Implement a simple system where users declare if they are driving and others express interest in joining.

Open Questions (must answer before building)

- How can the time saved with the new feature be effectively demonstrated to users?
- Should passengers select specific drivers or be presented with all available options?

Assumptions to Validate

- Users often prefer public transport over carpooling if it is more convenient.
- Current organizational methods are suboptimal and need improvement through new features.

Blockers & Risks

- Complexity of calculations for optimizing carpool routes and times.

- Logistical constraints such as car capacities and geographical limitations for pick-up/drop-off.

Next Actions

- Product Manager to develop a simple Discord feature to test its effectiveness in transportation logistics management.

Parking Lot (interesting ideas, not in scope yet)

- Feature for passengers to select preferred drivers for specific events.
- Optimization of passenger-driver preferences for future events, not initial trainings.

Nothing identified for Success Criteria & Metrics — may need follow-up.